hours of heat energy, which is enough to power an incandescent lightbulb for eleven thousand years, or a human being for just as long if we ran on nuclear fuel instead of grocery-store food.

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So ends our cosmic journey through the Periodic Table of Chemical Elements, right to the edge of the solar system, and beyond. For reasons I have yet to understand, many people don't like chemicals, which might explain the perennial movement to rid foods of them. Perhaps sesquipedalian chemical names just sound dangerous. But in that case we should blame the chemists, and not the chemicals themselves. Personally, I am quite comfortable with chemicals, anywhere in the universe. My favorite stars, as well as my best friends, are all made of them.

† For old-timers, this layer was formerly known as the Cretaceous-Tertiary (K-T) boundary.
†† Actually, Earth is my favorite planet. Then Saturn.